chairmanship of the Tuticorin Municipality and presidentship of the District Board but made no mention of his founding role in SSNCo![6] Further, it is inexplicable that someone like Parali Nellaiyappa Pillai, who lived a long life, spent many years as a journalist including as editor of a well-regarded journal, *Lokobakari*, and wrote copiously never put down his reminiscences. The brevity of his biography of VOC is frustrating, to say the least. One also wonders why Somasundara Bharati who lived a long life —he died in 1959 at the age of eighty, more than a decade after Independence—and was a prolific author never recorded his memories.

One fall-out of the Ashe assassination was the destruction of evidence by Swadeshi partisans. Understandably, the direct link between the assassination of an ICS officer—as collector and district magistrate the very symbol of British authority in the districts—and the Swadeshi movement terrified those involved in the movement.

If some destroyed potentially incriminating documents, a few went to the extent of ingratiating themselves with their colonial masters. K.R. Guruswami Aiyar acted as pallbearer to Ashe's coffin, one of the 'eight Representative gentlemen [who bore] the coffin'.[7] He also took the lead in organizing condolence meetings. Apart from presiding over public meetings at Thachanallur and at Tinnevelly Bridge, Guruswami Aiyar conducted meetings as lead office bearer of the Tinnevelly District Association, the Tinnevelly Bar Association, and the Saiva Samayabhivrithi Sabhai, Palayamkottai. A. Sundara Sastri, as secretary of the Hindu College, declared a holiday as soon as it reopened after the long summer vacation.

A proposal was floated to erect a memorial to Ashe. Funds were raised and a subscription of Rs 3,002 was collected exclusively from Indians—with one European exception. The thirty-eight subscribers included a few who had backed SSNCo such as S.V. Nallaperumal Pillai. G. Coreira (of the Bravi Senna Press, whose proprietor Bravi Roche Victoria had stood as defence witness for VOC) contributed Rs 50. The Ashe Memorial, an octagonal mandapam, set in a garden, was erected at the eastern end of the Great Cotton Road where it hits the Beach Road. While the foundation stone was laid on 2 April 1912, it was inaugurated on 28 August 1913 by